

Beyond Assembly



When a company with a market capitalisation of \$4 trillion becomes India's largest electronics exporter, it is time to take notice. Few companies command the kind of economic and political influence that Apple does.

That clout was evident when the President of the United States, Donald Trump, weighed in on the decision of Chief Executive Officer Tim Cook to step down. Yet, as the transition plays out in Cupertino, another story is unfolding in Sriperumbudur, Devanahalli and Sri City—Apple's smartphone exports from the country touched \$23 billion in 2025, a milestone in India's manufacturing ambitions.

For years, India has asked whether it can become a manufacturing powerhouse. Recent global turmoil and India's import dependence across sectors have made that question even more important.

As *Shelley Singh* writes in the cover story of this issue, Apple may well be creating a Maruti Suzuki-like moment for India's electronics sector as the company and its global supply chain begin to transform India's electronics manufacturing landscape. Why? In 2025, the company churned out around 55 million iPhones in India, accounting for 14% of its global production here, its only production site outside China.

India's smartphone exports were almost non-existent in 2014 when Prime Minister Narendra Modi announced the 'Make in India' initiative. The policy push appears to be finally delivering results. The handset export boom led by Apple is even more striking because it has happened despite political resistance in the US. Trump has publicly opposed Apple shifting production to India and repeatedly urged the company to manufacture in the US instead. However, much of this is still assembly. The future will depend on how far manufacturers like Apple and Samsung move beyond assembly and increase domestic value addition.

Elsewhere in this issue, *Neetu Chandra Sharma* writes about the road to recovery at Lupin. After a rough patch, India's sixth-largest pharma company made a strong comeback. The company's leadership, the brother-sister duo of Nilesh and Vinita Gupta, say businesses cannot operate with an outdated model. They must refresh themselves and build new capabilities, as no business model can last forever.

Meanwhile, our Business Confidence Survey, which captures the mood of India Inc., has been revamped. It now looks ahead and assesses the confidence and plans of businesses in the coming quarter. While the aim and design of the survey remain largely the same, the index now better captures the mood of India Inc. in an era of unprecedented change and volatility. As *Surabhi* explains, the war in West Asia has created fresh challenges for the economy. India Inc. is worried and many companies are evaluating the impact of the disruption on their investment decisions and business strategy for the year ahead.

The handset boom offers hope, but companies and policy-makers must now aim higher and focus on expanding the domestic supply chain and deepen electronics manufacturing in the country. **BT**

Siddharth

siddharth.zarabi@businesstoday.in
@sazarabi

Business Today

<http://www.businesstoday.in>

Chairman & Editor-in-Chief: Aroon Purie
Vice Chairperson & Executive Editor-in-Chief: Kalli Purie
Group Chief Executive Officer: Dinesh Bhatia
Chief Operating Officer: Alok Nair
Group Editor: Siddharth Zarabi
Chief AI Officer, Group Creative Editor: Nilanjan Das
Group Photo Editor: Bandep Singh
Executive Editor: Krishna Gopalan

Editor (Special Projects): Tina Edwin
Economy Editor: Surabhi
Senior Editor: Neetu Chandra Sharma
Associate Editor (Banking): Nachiket Kelkar
Associate Editors: Chetan Bhutani, Karan Dhar
Senior Assistant Editors: Palak Agarwal, Richa Sharma
Special Correspondent: Karishma Asoodani
Principal Correspondents: Aishwarya Patil

RESEARCH

Chief of Research Bureau: Jyotindra Dubey
Deputy Research Analyst: Prince Tyagi

COPY DESK

Senior Editor: Mahesh Jagota
Associate Editor: Vikram Gopal
Assistant Editors: Bitasta Basu, Kamalika Ghosh

PHOTOGRAPHY

Senior Photographer: Hardik Chhabra
Photo Coordinator: Vidushi Mehrotra

ART

Art Director: Rahul Sharma
Associate Art Directors: Rajesh Kumar Angira, Raj Verma
Senior Designer: Uma Shankar

EVENTS

Chief Manager: Sourabh Dutta

PRODUCTION

Chief of Production: Harish Aggarwal
Deputy Manager: Narendra Singh
Production Coordinator: Ayeekam David Meitei

LIBRARY

Librarian: Satbir Singh
Executive Secretary: Jyoti Kochhar

BUSINESS TEAM

Publisher: Siddhartha Chatterjee
General Manager & North Head: Ateet Dhandu
Assistant General Manager (Mumbai): Rohit Subramanian
Assistant General Manager (Chennai): P. Varunam
Assistant General Manager (Govt Sales): Manoj Gotherwal

AD OPS

Deputy General Manager: Avinash Karkera
Marketing: Vivek Malhotra, Group Chief Marketing Officer
Newsstand Sales: Deepak Bhatt,
Assistant Vice President – Sales and Distribution;
Rajeev Gandhi, General Manager (North);
Yogesh Godhanlal Gautam, Regional Sales Manager (West);
Manawer Hossain, Regional Sales Manager (East)



**Vol. 35, No. 10, for the fortnight April 27, 2026,
to May 10, 2026. Released on April 27, 2026.**

● Editorial Office: India Today Mediaplex, FC 8, Sector 16/A, Film City, Noida-201301;
Tel: 0120-4807100; Fax: 0120-4807150 ● Advertising Office (Gurgaon): A1-A2, Enkay Centre,
Ground Floor, V.N. Commercial Complex, Udyog Vihar, Phase 5, Gurgaon-122001;
Tel: 0124-4948400; Fax: 0124-4030919; Mumbai: 1201, 12th Floor, Tower 2 A, One World Center
(Jupiter Mills), S.B. Marg, Lower Parel (West), Mumbai-400013; Tel: 022-69193355;
Fax: 022-66063226; Chennai: 5th Floor, Main Building No. 443, Guna Complex, Anna Salai,
Teynampet, Chennai-600018; Tel: 044-28478525; Fax: 044-24361942; Bangalore: 202-204
Richmond Towers, 2nd Floor, 12, Richmond Road, Bangalore-560025; Tel: 080-22212448,
080-30374106; Fax: 080-22218335; Kolkata: 52, J.L. Road, 4th floor, Kolkata-700071;
Tel: 033-22825398, 033-22827726, 033-22821922; Fax: 033-22827254; Hyderabad: 6-3-885/7/B,
Raj Bhawan Road, Somajiguda, Hyderabad-500082; Tel: 040-23401657, 040-23400479;
Ahmedabad: 2nd Floor, 2C, Surya Rath Building, Behind White House, Panchwati,
Off: C.G. Road, Ahmedabad-380006; Tel: 079-65603393, 079-65609299; Fax: 079-6565293;
Kochi: Karakatt Road, Kochi-682016; Tel: 0484-2377057, 0484-2377058; Fax: 0484-370962
● Subscriptions: For assistance contact Customer Care India Today Group, C-9, Sector-10,
Noida (UP) - 201301.
Email: wecare@intoday.com | Phone / Whatsapp: +91 8597 778 778 (Monday to Friday, 10 am-6 pm)

● Sales: General Manager Sales, Living Media India Ltd, C-9, Sector 10, Noida (U.P.) - 201301;
Tel: 0120-4019500; Fax: 0120-4019664 © 1998 Living Media India Ltd.
All rights reserved throughout the world. Reproduction in any manner is prohibited.

● Printed & published by Manoj Sharma on behalf of Living Media India Limited.
Printed at Thomson Press India Private Limited, 18-35, Milestone, Delhi-Mathura Road,
Faridabad-121007, (Haryana). Published at F-26, First Floor, Connaught Place, New Delhi-110001.
Editor: Siddharth Zarabi

● Business Today does not take responsibility for returning unsolicited publication material.
All disputes are subject to the exclusive jurisdiction of competent courts and forums in
Delhi/New Delhi only.



For reprint rights and syndication enquiries, contact
syndications@intoday.com or call +91-120-4078000

www.syndicationtoday.in